

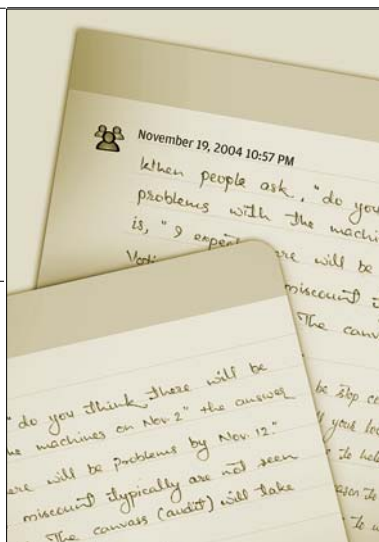
Kriba Shanker
Documentation Engineer
Brooks Automation

Back in 1988, I had my own Web site, way before the blogging concept caught fire. I updated my pages manually and FTPed them to the server. Needless to say, this was a painful process. And so it was like manna from heaven when I stumbled upon Blogger.com in 2001.

Being a technology columnist, I know the hassle of getting an article published—the synopsis, the approval, the editing and the god-knows-when-it-will-be-published quandary. Now, I can publish my writings anytime. Also, the fact that I constantly feed in information is reason enough for visitors to come back for more.

The number of contacts I have been able to make via blogging is amazing. I have attended almost all the bloggers' meets and met interesting personalities. It's amazing to see the number of job offers that I get from visitors. It also helps me earn extra money: ever since I included Google's AdSense, my blog has earned me more than what I had spent on the domain name and server space.

POSTS



Kaushal Karkhanis
Senior Visualiser
Hungama.com

The first posts on my blog were in July 2003. Although much of my blog is personal in nature, I figured it would make more sense talking about professional life and my learnings (like designing tips, etc), because it would have value for my readers—especially the “community.”

Sure, it has helped me network with peers. A lot of people liked the postings—especially the tips—and I have made several business, professional and personal friends via blogging. It's like a personal sphere with a professional core to it. Personal homepages minus the garb, but added value to the reader.

As for how the idea (to blog) materialised, well, it just happened. When you share a passion with peers who are always in touch with you, and everyone knows what each one's been up to, it's really an upbeat environment. And enthusiasm is always contagious, blogs or not. So when people visit my blog and discuss my posts, my thoughts, it's a very one-on-one interactive process of “mindsharing.”



Vikas Kamat
Independent Technology
Consultant

I began blogging in July 2001. The idea of incremental building of thoughts attracted me to it, and so did the fact that it removed editorial barriers. I have made a great number of (social) friends via my blog AnthoBLOg (<http://www.kamat.com/vikas/blog.htm>). I read a couple of blogs, and feel I know the bloggers very well, even though I have never communicated with them. Thus, I have built a “silent networking relationship” with them.

My blog is a kind of personal incubator of projects. At the time I started to blog, I had the attention of loyal readers (of www.kamat.com)—many of whom liked the idea. I use my blog as a “draft” of my ideas and projects. My readers quickly point out mistakes or mis-steps.

While I do not use my blog for professional development, the software I developed to write my blog (called *SimplyBlog*) is being used by many companies in India and across the world for professional growth and idea percolation.

As told to Garfield D'Souza